Eight Steps to a Written Picture of Mom's Care Situation

At your family's pace: eight actions in order, with a line for who does each and by when.

The goal: one written picture of how Mom's week works today and who helps with what, kept where the family can find it.

There's no deadline on this. Share the list, put a name next to each step, add a date only if a date helps, and tick each one when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Write down where Mom lives and who helps her there, with family, friends and neighbors included.			
2. Ask Mom to walk you through an ordinary day: morning, daytime, evening and overnight. Write what she says.			
3. List the family members and the professionals she already sees, with a phone number for each.			
4. Next to each person, write what they actually do and how often, including the small things.			
5. Ask the person who does the most for her which of their jobs are getting harder to keep up. Write the answer as they give it.			
6. With Mom's say-so, gather the notes that already exist, such as what was written down at an appointment.			
7. Sort what you have into three lists: what you know for certain, what someone has noticed, and what nobody knows yet.			
8. Read the page back to Mom where possible, then share it with the family, and let each person correct their part.			

You're done when

A written picture of Mom's current situation exists, everyone in the family knows where it is kept, and you've agreed when you'll look at it again: a date, or the kind of everyday change that would make it worth updating. A professional's review of that picture isn't on this list. This plan is the family's part.

If a step stalls

- Don't fill a gap by guessing. “Not yet known” is a finished line.
- If Mom would rather not talk about it today, leave it. It's her week to describe, and there will be another afternoon.
- If one step is stuck, go on to the next. The order helps, and nothing here has to be finished by a date.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes the family's part. Finishing it isn't a statement about Mom's health or safety, doesn't say how she is managing, and decides nothing about her care. It doesn't stand in for a professional's review.

Ready for the next step?

You've worked through the steps at your own pace, and the family has one written picture. The care interview takes it further: it asks about Mom's situation area by area, so nothing is left out, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›